



THE KENYA NATIONAL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education



101/1 –

ENGLISH
(Functional Skills)
Nov. 2017 – 2 hours

– Paper 1

Name Index Number

Candidate's Signature Date

Instructions to candidates

- (a) Write your name and index number in the spaces provided above.
- (b) Sign and write the date of examination in the spaces provided above.
- (c) Answer **all** the questions in this paper.
- (d) All your answers must be written in the spaces provided in the question paper.
- (e) **This paper consists of 8 printed pages.**
- (f) **Candidates should check the question paper to ascertain that all the pages are printed as indicated and that no questions are missing.**
- (g) **Candidates must answer the questions in English.**

For Examiner's Use Only

Question	Maximum Score	Candidate's Score
1	20	
2	10	
3	30	
Total Score		



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101/1

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Turn over



2. Read the passage below and fill in each blank space with an appropriate word. (10 marks)

A rich vocabulary can only be acquired through wide reading, and can only be (a)
..... in the mind through (b) extensive reading. Dictionaries are useful up to
a point. They give information where needed. (c) the exact flavour of a word can
only (d) familiar with repeated encounters of (e) in different contexts. It is
(f) remembering that we acquire (g) all our active vocabulary without the
help of a dictionary at all. (h) in the acquisition of vocabulary, the course book and the
dictionary are mere (i) in a more natural process founded chiefly (j).....
leisure-time reading.

Adapted from: Practical English; *A Comprehensive Secondary Course*, Teachers' Book by
P. A. Ogunidipe and P. S. Tregidgo, London: WPS, 1968.

3. (a) Read the Song below, and answer the questions that follow: (30 marks)

Maize has a market
Sorghum has a market
Maize has a market
What about my children?
My children's market is the graveyard
What about my children?
My children's market is the graveyard
You are a backbiter
You are a witch
You are a gossip
My children
You will kill them because of jealousy
My children
You will kill them because of jealousy.

Adapted from Magomoro: *Portrait of an African Village* (1987) Landeg White, Cambridge
University Press, 1987





- (i) With an illustration in each case, identify any three features that contribute to the oral nature of the song. (6 marks)

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.....

- (ii) Briefly explain why the word “You” should be stressed while performing the song. (2 marks)

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.....

- (b) Identify a sound feature in each of the short forms given below. (6 marks)

- (i) Challenger: It can be cracked, It can be made.
It can be told, It can be played.
What is it?
Respondent: A joke

.....

.....

- (ii) A good wife and health are man’s best wealth.

.....

.....

- (iii) Ken can can a can of curled Kales.

.....

.....



- (e) You have just attended a public meeting where various speakers were sensitizing people on the problem of cheating in national examinations. A news reporter who was covering the function decides to interview you.
Fill in the gaps in the conversation so that it flows naturally.

Reporter: Hello, what is your name and what do you do?

You:
..... (1 mark)

Reporter:
..... (1 mark)

You: I found the talk both enlightening and useful.

Reporter: What is the most outstanding thing that you have learnt today?

You:
.....
..... (2 marks)

Reporter:
.....
..... (1 mark)

You: I would like to tell them that
..... (1 mark)

Reporter:
..... (1 mark)

